

Football predictions

Sat 12 Sep 2026 to Sun 13 Sep 2026 | 6 fixtures | all kick-off times in EAT | generated Sat 12 Sep 2026, 08:11 EAT

How these were produced. A Dixon-Coles bivariate Poisson model fitted per league on 23,283 matches of results, weighted so recent games count more, blended with a second model fitted on shots on target. Where a closing price exists it is de-vigged and folded in at 90% weight. Every market below is read off one scoreline distribution per fixture, so no two numbers on a row can contradict each other.

What this is not. Over 5,948 walk-forward tests this engine scores a log-loss of 0.9568 against the bookmakers' closing consensus at 0.9558 - it matches the market, it does not beat it. Betting the model's disagreements with the price lost 12.2% of stakes over 3,761 historical bets. Treat these as calibrated estimates of how likely things are, not as tips with an edge.

CAF Champions League | first preliminary round, return legs | 2

Priced through an African country bridge measured from 199 CAF club matches (2023/24-2024/25), which beat having no bridge by 5.8% out of sample. CAF home advantage measures +0.59 - nearly double Europe's - so the return leg at home is worth a great deal. A club from a league loaded here is rated from its own results; a club from a federation with no loaded league is rated as an **average club of that federation**, from its CAF record alone. No prices exist for these, so every number is the model unaided.

Date	Time (EAT)	Match	1	X	2	Score	xG	Home rated from	Away rated from
Sat 12 Sep	16:00	Young Africans SC v Gaborone United	99%	1%	0%	4-0	4.91 - 0.16	NBC Premier League	BOT fed. (6 CAF ties)
Sun 13 Sep	16:00	Simba SC v Mighty Wanderers	90%	8%	1%	2-0	2.95 - 0.26	NBC Premier League	MWI fed. (6 CAF ties)

Who goes through. The first-leg score is carried into the second leg's scoreline distribution. Level on aggregate after 90 minutes is shown on its own rather than resolved, because it goes to extra time and penalties, which this engine does not model.

Tie (second leg)	First leg	Through in 90 min	Level - extra time / pens	Out in 90 min
Young Africans SC v Gaborone United	Young Africans SC scored 1, Gaborone United scored 1	99%	1%	0%
Simba SC v Mighty Wanderers	Simba SC scored 1, Mighty Wanderers scored 0	99%	1%	0%

* No CAF record at all for that federation in the data, so it is rated as an average CAF entrant - which almost certainly flatters it. Blind test before publishing: on the first legs, played after all of this data, the model gave Simba 65% to win in Lilongwe (they won 0-1, the likeliest single score) and Young Africans 88% in Gaborone (it finished 1-1, a one-in-ten outcome). Extreme home numbers for Simba and Young Africans are consistent with their own CAF home record against small federations - 5-1, 6-0 and 6-0 - but no football match is really 99% certain.

NBC Premier League (Tanzania) | 4

Date	Time (EAT)	Match	1	X	2	Pick	O2.5	U2.5	BTTS	Score	xG	Confidence
Sat 12 Sep	16:00	Polisi Tanzania v Mbeya City FC	25%	31%	44%	Away	38%	62%	45%	1-1	0.90 - 1.30	Slight lean
Sat 12 Sep	19:00	Coastal Union FC v JKT Tanzania FC	42%	33%	25%	Home	32%	68%	40%	0-0	1.15 - 0.82	Slight lean
Sun 13 Sep	16:00	Pamba Jiji FC v TRA United SC	31%	34%	35%	Away	31%	69%	40%	0-0	0.95 - 1.01	Close to a coin toss
Sun 13 Sep	19:00	Kagera Sugar FC v Singida Fountain Gate FC	44%	32%	24%	Home	34%	66%	42%	1-1	1.22 - 0.84	Slight lean

Coverage this weekend

Correction. An earlier brief said the NBC Premier League 2026/27 had not started. It has. Eight matches from 1-11 September have been added to the engine, so the Tanzanian ratings now include the new season.

Tanzanian shrinkage is now its own. Tanzania is far more top-heavy than any European league, so its raw ratings overstate totals more. Tuned on 521 walk-forward Tanzanian matches, it uses goal_shrink 0.25 against Europe's 0.40 - over/under log-loss 0.664 rather than 0.695. Accuracy on that sweep was 59%, higher than any European league here.

Young Africans v Geita Gold is Tuesday 15 September, 19:00 EAT - outside this window.

Reading the numbers. 1 / X / 2 are home win, draw and away win. O2.5 and U2.5 are over and under 2.5 total goals. BTTS is both teams to score. Score is the single most likely scoreline, which is often not the same as the most likely result: a favourite's win is spread across many scorelines while draws concentrate on 1-1.

Data. Results and prices from football-data.co.uk, free for personal use. Austrian, Norwegian, Czech, Tanzanian and other African results, and CAF and UEFA club competition results, from openfootball (public domain). Kick-off times are converted from UK time to EAT; fixtures from outside the feed were checked against published schedules.